

MD KOWSHAR AHMED

Cloud DevOps Engineer | Identity & Access Management | Platform Engineer | DevSecOps Engineer

📞 405-479-8989 @ aiops.kowshar@gmail.com 🔗 linkedin.com/in/kowsharahmed 📍 Dallas, TX

SUMMARY

Senior Cloud DevOps Engineer with extensive experience securing **AWS IAM** and automating multi-account infrastructure in regulated healthcare and financial services. Led IAM security remediation projects that reduced privilege-escalation risk and cut remediation cycle time by **50% through Terraform pipelines and Python automation**. Delivered **CI/CD pipelines with integrated security checks, improving deployment reliability and compliance**. Seeking to leverage deep IAM and automation expertise to strengthen cloud security and operational efficiency for the organization.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Enhanced Recovery Protocols**
Reduced disaster-recovery time by 45% through automated Kubernetes workflows across AWS regions.
- **Optimized Application Uptime**
Increased application availability to 99.9% by automating observability and alerting in AWS.
- **Implemented DevSecOps Controls**
Reduced security vulnerabilities by 60% using automated DevSecOps controls in CI/CD pipeline.
- **Improved Incident Response**
Decreased incident response time by 30% with centralized logging and containerized deployment pipelines.

SKILLS

Security & Compliance

- CloudTrail KMS SSM Parameter Store Secrets Manager
- AWS Config Wiz Prisma Cloud CIEM
- HIPAA compliance

Scripting & Automation

- Python/boto3 AWS CLI Bash

Infrastructure as Code & Delivery

- Terraform CloudFormation AWS CDK Jenkins
- GitLab CI GitHub Actions AWS CodePipeline
- Kubernetes

EDUCATION

MBA, Management Information Systems
[Lincoln University](#)
📍 California

CERTIFICATIONS

[AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate](#)
Date issued: July 29, 2026 Expires: July 29, 2029

SKILLS

Identity & Access Management

AWS IAM (roles, managed/inline/trust policies, permission boundaries, access keys)

STS/AssumeRole AWS Organizations & SCPs

ABAC/tagging IAM Access Analyzer Access Advisor

Governance at Scale

AWS Organizations Service Control Policies

Multi-Account Security Architecture

EXPERIENCE

Cloud DevOps Engineer

UnitedHealthcare / Optum 📅 10/2023 - Present 📍 Texas

- Cut stale identities and over-permissioned access keys by 50% by right-sizing IAM permissions and enforcing tag standards mandated by governance and compliance requirements through Terraform pipelines
- Reduced least-privilege remediation cycle time by 40% by building Python/boto3, AWS CLI, and Bash automation that analyzed IAM Access Analyzer findings and applied approved policy changes at scale across a multi-account AWS environment
- Strengthened cross-account governance for 200+ AWS accounts by implementing IAM trust policies, STS/AssumeRole flows, permission boundaries, and Organizations SCP controls aligned to least-privilege standards
- Reduced false-positive access findings by 35% by correlating CloudTrail activity, IAM Access Analyzer results, and Access Advisor usage data with application owners during recurring access reviews
- Improved production resilience by automating disaster-recovery testing and failover workflows for Kubernetes workloads, cutting recovery time by 45% across AWS regions

Cloud DevOps Engineer

Change Healthcare 📅 12/2022 - 10/2023 📍 Texas

- Reduced security-vulnerability escape rate by 50% by integrating automated policy validation, IaC security scanning, and Git-based remediation workflows directly into CI/CD pipelines
- Maintained 99.9% application availability across production AWS architectures (EC2, RDS, CloudWatch) by implementing automated observability and alerting controls
- Cut false-positive alert volume by 40% by deploying Prometheus, Grafana, and Splunk monitoring and validating findings jointly with engineering teams
- Eliminated 15 hardcoded and exposed secrets across production services by migrating credentials to AWS KMS, SSM Parameter Store, and Secrets Manager with zero downtime

Cloud Engineer

ARM 📅 10/2021 - 11/2022 📍 Texas

- Reduced critical security vulnerabilities by 60% by enforcing DevSecOps controls, automated container-image scanning, and infrastructure policy validation across the CI/CD pipeline
- Cut deployment lead time by 50% by building Terraform-driven CI/CD pipelines that enabled zero-downtime, repeatable releases
- Reduced manual remediation effort by 30% by developing Python/boto3 and Bash automation to enforce infrastructure lifecycle and AWS security operations at scale
- Improved access-control consistency across 350+ AWS accounts by codifying IAM roles, policies, trust relationships, and permission boundaries as reusable Terraform modules

EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer

Citi Bank

📅 09/2019 - 10/2021 📍 Irving, TX

- Cut production incidents by 20% using centralized logging and observability for critical financial apps.
- Strengthened multi-account AWS access governance for 175+ accounts by auditing IAM policies, cross-account trust relationships, and STS/AssumeRole access patterns in a regulated financial-services environment
- Improved deployment confidence and cut production defects by 25% by integrating SonarQube quality gates and automated security controls into global CI/CD workflows

DevOps Engineer

USAA

📅 04/2018 - 09/2019 📍 San Antonio, TX

- Cut disaster-recovery restoration time by 40% by automating backup, AMI management, and recovery workflows with Python and AWS CLI
- Reduced operational incident response time by 30% by building containerized deployment pipelines and centralized Elastic Stack logging
- Remediated 25 stale credentials and access keys by identifying identity-hygiene gaps and driving controlled, Git-based change workflows

Build and Release Engineer

LA Care

📅 06/2016 - 03/2018 📍 California

- Cut release-coordination effort by 25% by automating J2EE build and release workflows using Jenkins and Chef configuration management
- Maintained a fully auditable HIPAA-compliant release process by implementing controlled promotion, review, and deployment procedures across multi-stage environments